

BLKEXPORT User Guide

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**Software
Version 1.1**

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2. Quick Start: DXF to BOM in 3 steps

1. Open

File > Open DXF or Ctrl+O. Pick your drawing.

→ Check *Integrity Summary* shows PASS.

2. Review

Click the tabs: **Attributed** | **Non-Attributed** | **Anonymous**

→ These are your blocks, auto-sorted.

3. Export

Ctrl+E = Full block schedule CSV (purple button)

Ctrl+B = Summarised BOM CSV (green button)

Done. Open the CSV in Excel.

3. Overview

BLKEXPORT is a desktop utility designed to process DXF drawings and identify block insertions. The application categorises blocks into Anonymous Blocks, Non-Attributed Blocks, and Attributed Blocks, then allows the results to be exported to CSV files. It also provides a summarised BOM (Bill of Materials) export and full block schedule export.

4. Who is *BLKEXPORT* for?

BLKEXPORT is designed for anyone who needs to generate a Bill of Materials (BOM) from AutoCAD drawings. It automatically extracts all blocks from a drawing and compiles them into a BOM.

Landscape architects can use BLKEXPORT to count every plant and tree in a landscape design. M&E engineers can generate a list of all electrical components in a building. Process engineers can produce a BOM from P&ID drawings to schedule valves, vessels, pumps, and other equipment.

If your drawings use blocks, BLKEXPORT can generate your BOM automatically.

5. System Requirements & Known Limits

Minimum Requirements

- **OS:** Windows 10 64-bit or Windows 11 64-bit
- **RAM:** 4 GB
- **Display:** 1280×720 minimum
- **Disk:** 50 MB free space
- **Dependencies:** None. Fully portable.

Tested Limits

- **DXF file size:** Up to 46 KB ASCII 29KB Binary for 100,000 blocks AutoCAD 2018 ASCII and AutoCAD 2018 DXF Binary
- **Block count:** Up to 100,000 blocks per file maximum blocks allowed progeCAD 2021
- **Attribute length:** 255 characters per attribute
- **DXF File format range supported:**
AutoCAD 2000 ASCII and AutoCAD 2000 Binary DXF through to AutoCAD 2018 ASCII and AutoCAD 2018 Binary DXF inclusive only. DWG not supported.
- **Block types not supported:** Dynamic and Smart Blocks.
- **DXF load latency:** When loading a DXF file containing 100,000 blocks, a loading time of around **2.5 minutes** can be expected. During this period, the **BLKEXPORT** software may appear to be non-responsive while the file is being processed. Actual load times will vary depending on the performance of the host computer. The 2.5-minute estimate is based on testing performed using the reference test machine specification defined below. Once the DXF file is loaded Exporting the summarised BOM and full block schedule to CSV is instant.

Tested On

- Operating System: Windows 11 Pro
- Operating System Version: 25H2
- Processor 13th Gen Intel(R) Core(TM) i9-13900 (2.00 GHz)
- Installed RAM 32.0 GB (31.6 GB usable)
- Graphics card Intel(R) UHD Graphics 770 (128 MB)
- Storage 1TB SSD
- Display 2560 × 1440 resolution
- System type 64-bit operating system, x64-based processor

Notes

- If *Integrity Summary* shows FAIL, check file format first.
- Network drives supported, but local SSD recommended for files >10MB.

6. Supported Files

Supported formats

DXF file format: AutoCAD 2018 ASCII (*.dxf) and AutoCAD 2018 Binary (*.dxf)

DWG not supported.

7. Install BLKEXPORT Software

The BLKEXPORT software comes with a built-in installer.

1. **Run the installer**
Right-click setup.exe and choose **Run as administrator**.
2. **Choose install location**
Keep the default path C:\Program Files\BLKEXPORT\ and click **Next**.
3. **Set user access**
Select **Install for all users**, then click **Install**.
4. **Finish**
When installation completes, the BLKEXPORT desktop icon will be created.

BLKEXPORT is now installed. Double-click the desktop icon to launch the application.

8. Uninstall BLKEXPORT Software

- 1. Launch Control Panel**
Press Win + R, type control, and press Enter.
- 2. Open Programs and Features**
Click **Programs > Programs and Features**.
- 3. Uninstall BLKEXPORT**
Scroll to **BLKEXPORT**, right-click, and choose **Uninstall**. Click **Yes** to confirm.
- 4. Done**
BLKEXPORT is now removed from your computer. The program files and desktop icon are also deleted automatically.

9. Software Interface

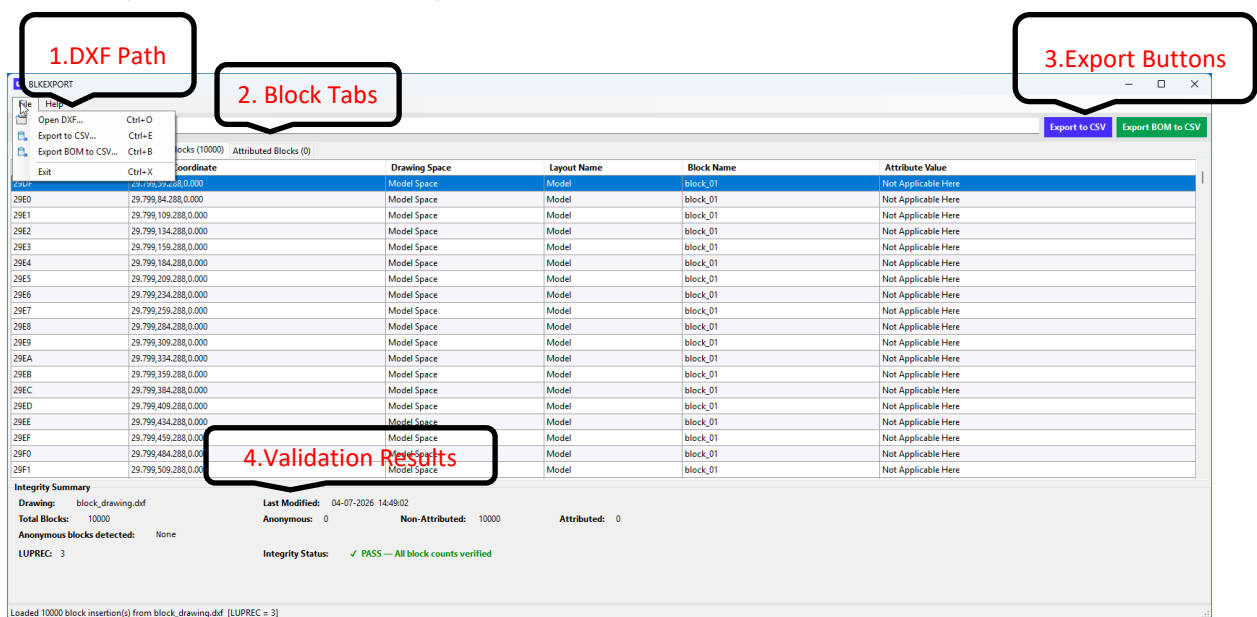


Figure 1 Main window after loading a DXF. Note the 3 block tabs for filtering and color-coded export buttons — purple for full schedule, green for BOM. Check the Integrity Summary bottom-right to confirm PASS before exporting

10. Menu Commands

File Menu:

- Open DXF (Ctrl+O) – Open and process a DXF drawing.
- Export to CSV (Ctrl+E) – Export full block schedule data purple button.
- Export BOM to CSV (Ctrl+B) – Export a summarised BOM (Bill of Materials) green button.
- Exit (Ctrl+X) – Close the application.

Help Menu:

- About – Displays application version, registration information and system information.

11. Loading a DXF File

1. Select File > Open DXF or press Ctrl+O.
2. Browse to the required DXF file.
3. The application processes the drawing and populates the block tables.
4. Review the Integrity Summary to confirm successful processing.

12. Block Categories

Anonymous Blocks – Displays anonymous block references detected in the drawing.

Non-Attributed Blocks – Lists blocks without attributes.

Attributed Blocks – Lists blocks containing attribute values.

13. Data Columns

Typical columns include:

- Handle – Unique entity handle.
- Insertion Coordinate – Block insertion point.
- Drawing Space – Model Space or Paper Space.
- Layout Name – Associated layout.
- Block Name – Name of the inserted block.
- Attribute Value – Attribute content when applicable.

14. Exporting Data

Export to CSV:

1. Load a DXF file.
2. Click Export to CSV purple button or press Ctrl+E.
3. Choose a save location.
4. Open the generated full block schedule CSV in Excel or another spreadsheet application.

Export BOM to CSV:

1. Click Export BOM to CSV green button or press Ctrl+B.
2. Select a destination folder.
3. Open the generated summarised BOM (Bill of Materials) CSV in Excel or another spreadsheet application.

15. Integrity Summary

The Integrity Summary section provides:

- Drawing name (dxf) and modification date.
- Total block count.
- Anonymous, attributed, and non-attributed block counts.
- LUPREC value used for coordinate precision.
- PASS/FAIL status confirming that detected block counts have been verified.

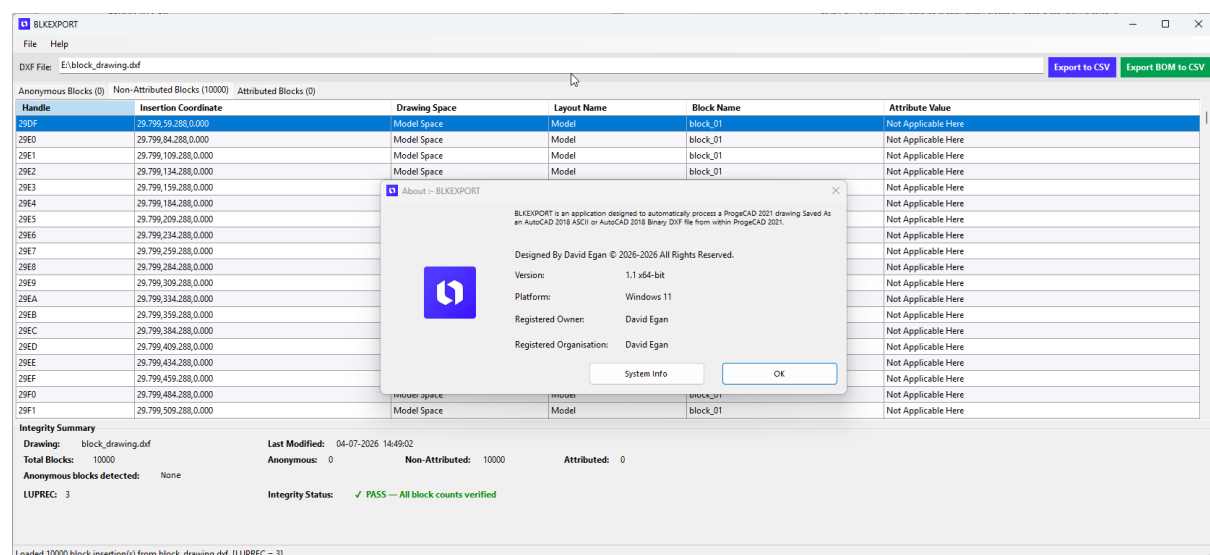


Figure 2

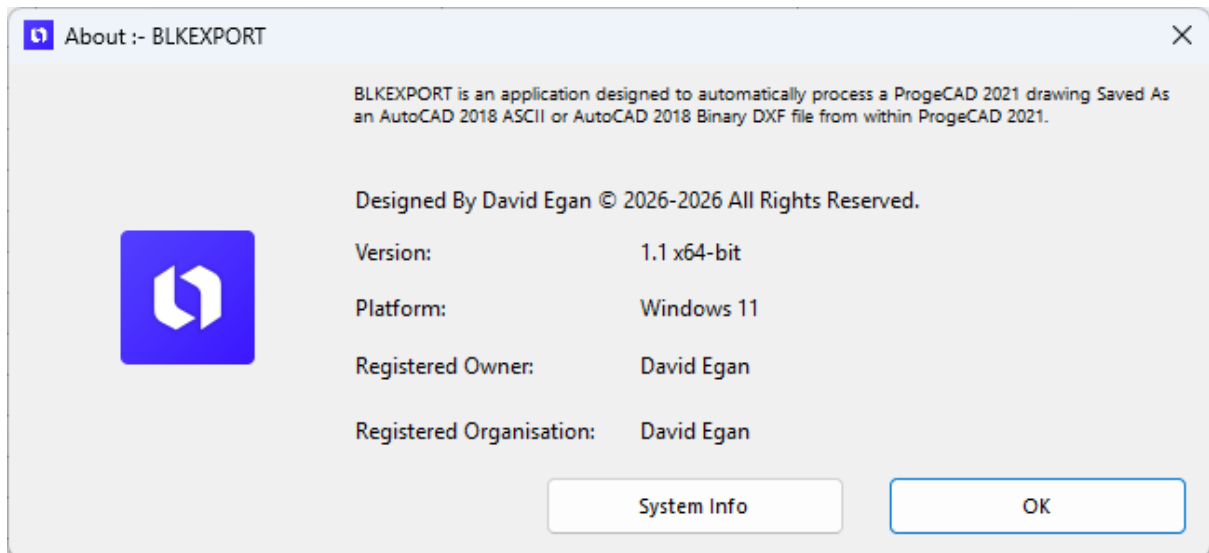


Figure 3 The About dialog displays version information, platform support, registration details, and access to system information

16. Software Design Philosophy

No AI. No fluff. Just engineering.

BLKEXPORT is built like the structures I trust — with reinforced concrete and steel.

What that means:

- **Predictable:** Does exactly what you expect, every time you run it.
- **Dependable:** No hidden calls home. No random updates breaking your workflow.
- **Built to last:** Engineered for real CAD work, not demos or trends.

I build software the way it was 20 years ago: solve the actual problem, then get out of your way.

Like a good bridge, it should work on day 1 and day 1001. Same result. No surprises.

That's the standard I hold myself to.
That's BLKEXPORT.

David Egan
Sole Software Developer & Systems Architect

17. Troubleshooting

No data displayed:

- Verify the selected file is a valid DXF.

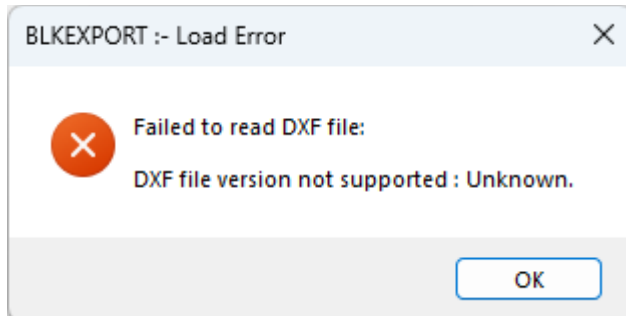


Figure 4 Invalid DXF file selected

- Ensure the drawing contains block insertions.

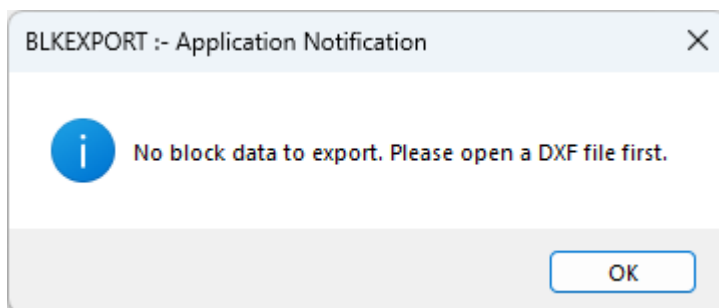


Figure 5 No blocks in the drawing to export or there is no drawing selected

Export unavailable:

- Load and process a DXF file first.
- Verify you have write permission to the target folder.

Integrity check failure:

- Re-save the drawing as a supported DXF format and reload it.

18. Keyboard Shortcuts

Ctrl+O – Open DXF file

Ctrl+E – Export to CSV in purple button

Ctrl+B – Export BOM to CSV in green button

Ctrl+X – Exit

19. The importance of meaningful block names

Using meaningful block names makes the Summarised BOM and Full Block Schedule CSV exports much easier to read and understand.

If your CSV exports contain obscure or generic block names, rename the blocks in your CAD software before exporting. You can use the Rename Blocks command in AutoCAD or progeCAD 2021 to assign descriptive, meaningful names to your blocks.

After renaming the blocks, save the DXF file and close it in your CAD application. The DXF file must be closed before opening it in the BLKEXPORT software.

Once the DXF file has been processed in BLKEXPORT, export the Summarised BOM or Full Block Schedule CSV again. The exported CSV files will now display your newly assigned block names, making them easier to interpret.

